

FISHKO — Stage 1 Business Plan

■1,000 Fresh Fish Harbour-to-Home Pilot

Objective: Prove that a small amount of working capital can be repeatedly converted into profitable fresh-fish sales before scaling.

1. The FISHKO Advantage

Advantage	How it helps
Harbour ~5 minutes away	Fast procurement and low travel cost.
5 years fishing experience	Strong knowledge of fish, seasonality and quality.
Mother at harbour in mornings	Early information about landings and supply.
Own/family vessels	Potential low-risk supply and direct catch.
Broker contacts	Better access to prices and available fish.
Small-quantity buying	No need to commit to bulk inventory.

2. Stage 1: Start With ■1,000

Expense	Initial limit
Fish purchase	■650–■750
Ice	■50–■100
Harbour/loading/travel/misc.	■50
Packaging	■50–■100
Cleaning	■0 initially if family handles it
Emergency reserve	■100
Total	■1,000

Rule: Do not spend the entire ■1,000 on fish. Keep a reserve for ice, packaging, transport or unexpected price changes.

3. Buy the Opportunity, Not a Particular Fish

The daily decision should be: **What fresh fish is available today at an unusually good harbour price and has enough local demand?**

For every fish, record: fish → harbour buy price → expected cleaned yield → customer selling price → expected demand → maximum buying price.

4. Profit Formula

Net profit = Customer revenue – fish purchase – cleaning – ice – packaging – transport – delivery – wastage.

Never calculate profit as selling price minus purchase price alone. Cleaning loss, ice, packaging, delivery and unsold stock can remove the apparent margin.

5. Maximum Buying Price

Example only: if expected selling price is ■450/kg and you require ■100/kg contribution, with estimated costs of cleaning ■20, ice ■10, packaging ■10, transport ■10 and risk/wastage ■20, the maximum purchase price is approximately ■280/kg.

Decision: ■240/kg = buy; ■275/kg = buy carefully; ■300/kg = do not buy, assuming the other assumptions remain valid.

6. Fish Selection System

Category	Criteria
A — BUY	Strong demand, fresh, good price, easy cleaning, likely same-day sale, sufficient margin.
B — BUY SMALL	Good fish but uncertain demand, premium price or limited market.
C — DON'T BUY	Poor margin, expensive, uncertain demand, difficult processing or high wastage risk.

7. Harbour Price Notebook

Build your own local price history. Online prices can be useful as reference, but the harbour price on the actual morning is what matters.

Fish	Today's price/kg	Normal price	Supply	Demand	Buy?
Mathi	■_____	■_____	High/Med/Low	High/Med/Low	Yes/No
Ayala	■_____	■_____	High/Med/Low	High/Med/Low	Yes/No
Choorā	■_____	■_____	High/Med/Low	High/Med/Low	Yes/No
Neymeen	■_____	■_____	High/Med/Low	High/Med/Low	Yes/No
Avoli	■_____	■_____	High/Med/Low	High/Med/Low	Yes/No
Netholi	■_____	■_____	High/Med/Low	High/Med/Low	Yes/No

8. Own and Family Vessel Supply

Treat own/family vessel fish as a separate supply channel. It can be excellent for early testing because it reduces cash risk. As the business grows, assign a transfer value/opportunity cost so that reported margins remain realistic.

9. Cleaning and Labour

Do not hire a permanent cleaner immediately. If family can handle the first small volumes, keep fixed costs near zero. Consider paid labour only after volume is consistently high enough to justify the cost.

10. Cold Chain and Next-Day Stock

Ice is an operational cost even if the brand message is 'never frozen/re-frozen.' Keep fish properly chilled from harbour to processing and delivery.

Today's catch should be prioritized for today's customers. Any next-day sale should happen only when the fish has been handled and chilled properly and still meets FISHKO's quality standard.

Important: Make the website promise match the actual operating model. Avoid absolute freshness claims that conflict with planned next-day inventory.

11. Morning Operating Schedule

Time	Activity
4:30–5:00	Check harbour situation and arrivals.
5:00–6:00	Observe supply, prices, quality and broker information; do not rush to buy.
~6:00	Choose fish and quantity based on customer demand and maximum buying price.
6:00–7:00	Transport home.
7:00–8:00	Clean/cut and prepare.
8:00–8:30	Pack and label.
8:30 onward	Local delivery.

12. ■100 Product Strategy

Use ■100 as an easy entry point, not as a universal price for every fish. Examples: ■100 sardine pack, ■100 small-fish pack, ■100 curry-cut pack, ■200 family pack, ■300 premium pack.

For the first-order promotion, avoid giving away the fish. Better options are **■100 off the first order** or **free delivery within a small local radius**. Free delivery on a ■100 order can destroy the margin if delivery costs ■40–■60.

13. Customer Acquisition

Start hyperlocal: neighbours, family friends, nearby houses, apartment/WhatsApp groups and existing contacts. The strongest message is not 'new online fish shop'; it is 'today's harbour catch, cleaned and delivered to your home.'

Use pre-orders whenever possible. Know the approximate customer demand before going to the harbour, then buy a small additional quantity only when the price and demand justify it.

14. Daily Numbers to Track

Metric	Record
Purchase cost	■_____
Sales revenue	■_____
Operating costs	■_____
Unsold/waste	■_____
Net profit	■_____
Repeat customers	_____
Average order value	■_____

15. Seven-Day Pilot

Day	Action
1	Visit harbour; record fish, prices, quality, brokers and arrival times. Do not focus on maximizing sales.
2	Repeat and compare price/supply patterns.
3	Buy only ■500–■700 of fish and sell to 3–5 customers.
4	Repeat and compare margins.
5	Test pre-orders.
6	Test ■100 entry packs.
7	Calculate margins, delivery cost/order, packaging cost, waste, average order value and repeat customers.

16. What NOT to Spend On Yet

- Large advertising budget
- Large inventory
- Permanent employee
- Large delivery area
- 20+ fish varieties
- Expensive freezer or infrastructure
- Fancy packaging
- Major website redesign

17. Example ■1,000 Experiment

Hypothetical example only: buy 3 kg at ■220/kg = ■660. Add ■50 ice, ■40 packaging, ■20 transport and ■30 miscellaneous costs. Total deployed = ■800. If sold at ■350/kg, revenue = ■1,050 and operating profit before valuing your own labour = ■250.

The purpose of the experiment is not to hit this exact margin; it is to establish your real harbour purchase price, real selling price, real costs and real demand.

18. Core Stage 1 Principle

Do not buy according to how much fish is available. Buy according to how much cash you can safely deploy and how much demand you can reasonably sell.

Scale only after the numbers prove themselves: ■1,000 → ■1,500 → ■2,500 → ■5,000, rather than committing large capital early.

Next operational document to build: a daily FISHKO buying sheet covering fish, harbour price, maximum buy price, quantity, expected sales, cleaning yield, ice, packaging, delivery and expected profit.